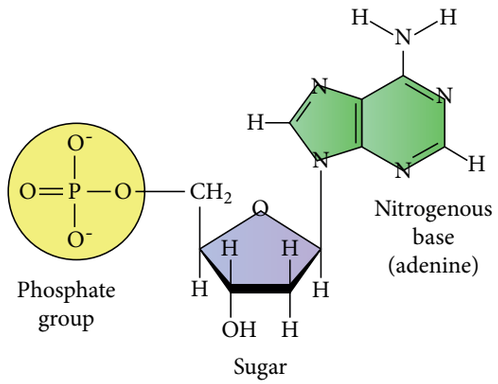
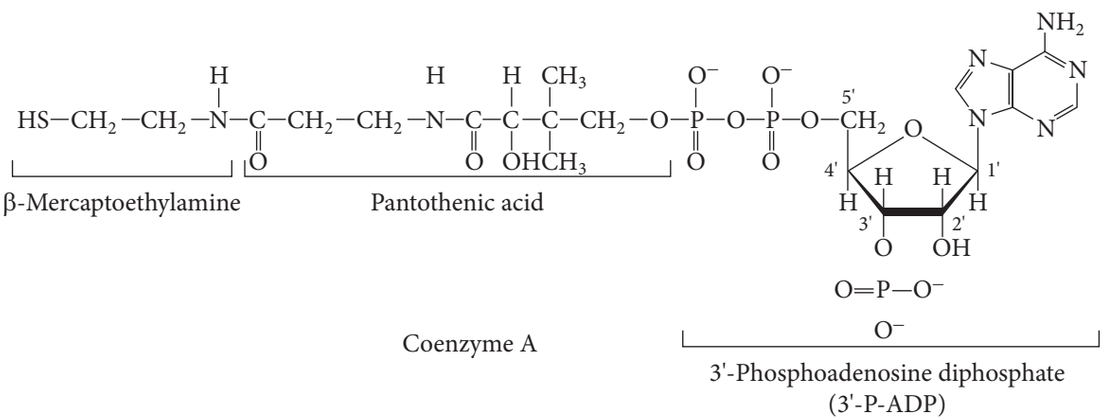
14.5.4 Biological functions of nucleic acids

In addition to their roles as the subunits of nucleic acids, nucleotides have a variety of other functions in every cell such as,

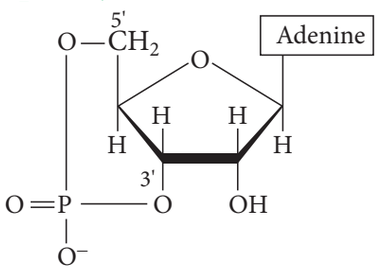
i. Energy carriers (ATP)



ii. Components of enzyme cofactors (Example: Coenzyme A, NAD^+, FAD)



iii. Chemical messengers (Example: Cyclic AMP, cAMP)



Adenosine 3', 5'-cyclic monophosphate
(cyclic AMP; cAMP)

14.6 HORMONES

Hormone is an organic substance (e.g. a peptide or a steroid) that is secreted by one tissue. it limits the blood stream and induces a physiological response (e.g. growth and metabolism) in other tissues. It is an intercellular signalling molecule. Virtually every

XII U14-Biomolecules_New.indd 266 11-01-2021 16:38:04